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Turning patients into profit

How Steward embodies the risk of private equity's push in American health care

Nearly 75 years ago, more than 6,000 people gathered on a Methuen hilltop, under dark skies and in a persistent drizzle. They held umbrellas or newspapers over their heads, and jockeyed for a spot to witness this grand opening.

The dedication of a new Catholic hospital, paid for by donations from the "rank and file," as their archbishop noted, was a momentous leap for their community.

Nancy Glynn, 13, sensed the magnitude of the moment. The schoolgirl was among the thousands who strolled through the hospital's open house that September day in 1950. Floors gleamed. New equipment sparkled. Nuns in all-white habits stood sentry at front-line medical posts.

A fund-raising drive, endorsed by the Boston Archdiocese in 1944, had brought in the dizzying sum of \$1 million to stand up the sprawling four-sto-

ry brick-and-mortar building. Businesses gave thousands; working people gave a dollar or two, whatever they could spare. Three years into World War II, people understood sacrifice for the greater good.

A submarine officer from Lawrence sent a \$25 check and a letter written in the waters near Okinawa. "I, and the submarine in which I have served, have caused so much destruction in this war
STEWART, Page A12



This story was reported and written by Mark Arsenault and Hanna Krueger.

Renewed push to ban fee on renters

Broker payment reviled as adding to housing costs

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — Moving to one of the most expensive rental markets in the world requires sacrifice. Most of those who opt to settle around here understand they will pay handsomely for the privilege, trading a high sticker price for access to colleges, culture, walkability.

What they may not know, but learn quickly, is that here — and almost nowhere else — there can be another barrier to entry: Tenants are typically required to pay a fee to their landlord's broker, usually a month's rent, before they can move in. A bitter pill, and one they may need to swallow several times as they move from place to place.

"The rent here is already so high. The fact that we also have to pay a broker fee is just insane to me," said Bryan Daley, 29, explaining he recently paid \$3,200 to a broker he met only once, briefly, during a tour of a two-bedroom Somerville unit via FaceTime. "We're not the ones who hire the broker, but we're the ones who have to pay them."

Among renters, the system is reviled, and a rite of passage in a tight market that gives enormous leverage to landlords.

Now, hoping to capitalize on the momentum from a New York City Council vote in November to prohibit tenant-paid fees, elected officials in Somerville, Cambridge, and Boston are mounting a newly invigorated effort to end the practice.

But unlike New York, where the city council was able to change the law on its own, communities in Massachusetts need
BROKER FEES, Page A8

'In many ways, it's like a rebirth. Here I am in my 80s and it's a whole new chapter.'

VILUNYA DISKIN, *on finally getting answers about her family*



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Vilunya Diskin held a photo of herself as a child. Diskin, now of Jamaica Plain, had long harbored questions about her parents and twin.

Finding family amid the tragedy of history

Noted feminist traces Holocaust journey and discovers her birth name and her parents

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

Vilunya Diskin's earliest memory is as a 4-year-old, traveling on a train through a country that no longer exists, being implored to stay quiet as she and others fled the genocidal violence convulsing much of Europe.

In the early 1940s, authorities had consigned her parents to a Jewish ghetto in their hometown, now known as Lviv, but Diskin escaped their fate when she was left in the care of others. The antisemitic persecution continued even after the Soviet Army liberated the city from the Nazis, as they sought to arrest the rabbi who was taking care of her because he rescued Jewish children from orphanages. So they fled in the middle of the night.

"What I remember is being very quiet, just not talking at all, because that's what he told me to do," she said of the train ride.

Diskin's flight would eventually bring her to the United States, where she was

adopted by a Jewish family and raised in California before settling in Boston as a young adult. She would become a feminist icon when she coauthored the seminal text "Our Bodies, Ourselves" in 1970.

But she never saw her parents again, nor did she know what had become of her twin sister. The answers would be lost to the cataclysm of the war until, eight decades later, she finally found out who she really is.

Memory can be a tricky thing. In Diskin's earliest recollection, she is the ward of a rabbi, Israel Leiter, and his family, and believes they had fled Poland and were traveling through what was then Czechoslovakia. Before Leiter, Diskin had been hidden away for years by a Catholic woman who had been a childhood friend of her father. Her twin sister wasn't so lucky. Unbeknownst to Diskin, her sibling was dead.

Years later, as a college student at the
DISKIN, Page A6

A warm place for more than just words

New bookstore by Boston poet laureate becomes immediate gathering spot



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Boston poet laureate Porsha Olayiwola (right) opened justBook-ish with her business partner, Bing Broderick.

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

"This is why I live here."

That's what Chernet Sisay told his girlfriend in late November when they attended the grand opening of justBook-ish, an independent bookstore in Fields Corner in Dorchester. He was struck by the diversity of the crowd.

"That made me a little bit emotional, that cultural melting pot," Sisay, 30, recalled while at the bookstore on a recent Friday. "I think there's something powerful about people of all walks of life coming together over a bookstore opening."

But it's not just any bookstore. Part of what's unique about just-

Book-ish is the team behind it: It was cofounded by the poet laureate of Boston, Porsha Olayiwola, and her business partner, Bing Broderick. And its mission is to highlight writers whose work challenges political paradigms. Olayiwola envisions it as "a literary gathering space," she said, "which means that you should theoretically be able to come in here, whether or not you can afford something, and feel comfortable."

The only independent bookstore in Dorchester, justBook-ish is also one of just a handful of Black-owned bookstores in Boston. Located north of the elevated Red Line T tracks, the storefront stands out amid a sea of
BOOKSTORE, Page A8

A new exhibit at the Worcester Historical Museum is a compelling reminder

that candlepin bowling, which originated in Worcester, was once king. **SundayArts, N1.**

Can't get away? Massachusetts offers many authentic experiences from other cultures. **SundayTravel, N11.**

The Globe Magazine is not publishing today. The puzzles can be found on **B4.**



Freeze frame

Sunday: Sunny, breezy. High: 31-36. Low 18-23.

Monday: Mostly sunny. High: 29-34. Low: 18-23.

Complete report, **A22.**
Deaths, **A16-21.**

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\$6.00

